

KYLE GAARDER

New Product Builder | Innovation, Belonging, Retention

720-232-6836

kylegaarder@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/kylegaarder

Austin, Texas

SUMMARY

Early-stage operator and product builder focused on designing environments where people gather, collaborate, and belong. I specialize in 0→1 initiatives -- launching new products, building communities, and creating systems that drive retention and growth. My background spans coworking, coliving, operations, community experience, and market creation. I thrive in ambiguous environments, run rapid experiments, work across teams, and turn ideas into real-world programs and products that people want to be part of.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 08/2022 - 07/2024
- Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months in an emerging housing model
 - Designed onboarding, communication, and conflict-resolution systems supporting long-term resident retention
 - Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 mastermind programs, and 6 work-trade programs to increase engagement and retention
 - Executed A/B testing on dynamic pricing models and stay-length diversification, resulting in a 48% increase in annual revenue while maintaining a consistent 94% occupancy rate
 - Directed full-cycle operations, overseeing everything from financial reporting to vendor procurement, improving operational efficiency 212% year-over-year
 - Facilitated acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining positive stakeholder relationships

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 01/2021 - 08/2022
- Portland, OR
- Built an early-stage demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots outreach and concept validation
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to guide product-market fit and business model
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Worked across strategy, operations, partnerships, and product concept development in an early-stage startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 01/2011 - 01/2016
- Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Client Growth & Retention**
Built niche service business to 140+ clients with 82% retention
- Revenue Growth**
Generated 46% YoY revenue growth through pricing, operations, and customer experience improvements
- Rapid Execution**
Launched and filled an 8-bed coliving property within 2 weeks, maintaining 94% occupancy for 19 months
- Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new housing concept
- Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 1,740 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Product development	
Program Design	Operations
Customer Experience	Retention
Community Engagement	
Rapid Experimentation	
Stakeholder Collaboration	
Partnerships	Market Creation
Facilitation	Conflict Resolution

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology	
Virginia Tech	GPA 3.5 / 4.0
08/2010 - 05/2014	
Virginia, USA	
Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish	